

BEAUTY ELECTRONICS

At Home



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Beauty appliances have the potential to boost the slowing down electronics market by attracting more female customers

*Jade face rollers
(Courtesy: www.allure.com)*



The rising quest of people to fulfil their beauty needs is leading to the development and popularity of fabulous electronic grooming tools. Electronics manufacturers see promise in a range of beauty gadgets targeting women in particular, from high-tech hair dryers to steam skin moisturisers.

Convergence of beauty with electronics

Originally, beauty-related electronic gadgets were mainly produced for and used by beauty professionals in hair salons and esthetic clinics. These began filtering into the consumer market about a decade ago and have picked up steam in the last few years. Lifestyle changes have provided a tailwind and consumers are increasingly becoming health- and beauty-conscious. Electronic beauty products have become a must for busy people who want to maintain their appearance. Beauty appliances have the potential to boost the slowing down electronics market by attracting more female customers.

Personal grooming equipment like shavers, trimmers, nose hair trimmers, ear hair trimmers, hair straightening irons and beauty curlers have long been available in the market. Mainstays in the beauty electronics market include skin steamers,

hair dryers and curling irons. The trend nowadays is to have these emit negative ions, which help keep skin and hair healthy. In fact, even skin moisturising gadgets based on this principle are now available. For instance, Sharp Corp. has developed a portable appliance that uses ions to keep skin moist. It weighs only 30 grams, and can be clipped to a jacket and taken anywhere.

Broadly, beauty appliances can be categorised based on following applications:

1. Facial and body massage
2. Eye fatigue relief
3. Hair treatment
4. Skin care

Market status

Japanese electronics industry is well known for its innovative products, but with the slowing down of electronics industry in terms of the demand for entertainment and communication electronic devices, industrialists are turning their attention towards health and beauty electronics. Japanese beauty industry isn't far behind in terms of innovativeness. Face razors, eyelash curlers, heating and cooling pads, and the infamous face rollers—all of these are beauty electronics that we can only find in Japan.

Inspired by growth in the domestic market, Japanese makers are looking to cultivate the overseas market for health and beauty products. Many makers are considering taking their products overseas as foreign competitors are yet to enter this category in a big way. Panasonic is among the front runners, which has already started selling its beauty electronics products in India and Europe. Rivals including South Korea's Samsung Electronics Co. are yet to enter the off-shore competition in beauty appliance field.

Devices at a glance

Beauty electronics can be defined as electronics that not only serves a function but also adds to the user's overall beauty in the process. These are a special type of home electronics devices that are meant for facial, hair and body care. Looking fabulous is easy with electrical beauty products, and you will